. Babur, *The Baburnama: Memoirs of Babur, Prince and Emperor*, trans. W.M. Thackston (Modern Library, 2002).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Ali Anooshahr's wonderful essay, 'The King Who Would Be Man: The Gender Roles of the Warrior King in Early Mughal History', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, vol. 18, no. 3 (Cambridge University Press, 2008), examines how their contemporaries perceived the relative 'manliness' of Humayun and Kamran. Anooshahr argues that the 'crucial distinction in gender roles' at this time amongst this class was 'not between effeminate and manly, but between not-yet-man and adult male'. The latter would not, for example, marry for desire, but for duty. Thus, the political failure of Humayun's marriage to Hamida, which cost him Hindal's loyalty, stands in sharp contrast with Kamran's manoeuvres to 'consolidate his own power through marriage-alliances' – as now with Sindh.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Ibid.
. Ibid.
. This time, with his son.
.*The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Ibid.
. Gulbadan Begum, *The History of Humayun*.
. Only a few months after this meeting, Humayun received a letter from his young uncle Haider. Years ago, at their last meeting in panic-stricken Lahore, Haider had suggested conquering Kashmir. He had followed through on his plan, marching into the mountains with 4000 men; and would rule Kashmir for over a decade. Now, he wrote to remind Humayun that he had a whole empire to recuperate in Hindustan; Humayun agreed in principle, and did nothing about it. Moreover, only months after sending a polite, non-committal reply to Haider, Humayun wrote off letters of his own – to Kamran, Askari, Hindal and Sulaiman – reminding them of their plans for Balkh, and inviting them to join his army. Hindustan, it seems, was off the agenda.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Ibid.
. Humayun's love and concern for his son pervades the chronicles. During his siege of Qandahar, for example, the padishah had asked for Akbar's auspicious horoscope as a way of comforting his fears for his son's future. Hamida was equally protective. When Akbar was six years old, he had a toothache that Humayun's eldest wife, Haji Begum, proposed to treat with a new paste. Hamida tried to smuggle Akbar away. She was 'in an agony lest [Haji Begum] should give me the medicine' Akbar remembered, but was unable to refuse the senior queen. Akbar, meanwhile, 'would not leave' Haji Begum's side. Luckily for the frantic Hamida, Haji Begum understood her fears; she ate some of the paste herself before rubbing it on Akbar's tooth. See *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. He was sent to Mecca, a euphemism for exile at the time, and died en route, sometime between October 1557 and October 1558.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Young Akbar was given to borrowing headgear, it seems. He credits himself with inventing the *kornish* – a bow in which one hand touches the lowered head, as if offering it in tribute – telling the story of how he was wearing a hat of Humayun's while bowing to his father. Akbar had to hold on to the oversized hat as he bent down, and so the salute came about. See Abul Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (first published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu'l Fazl*, vol. 1.
. Though Abul Fazl insists that Humayun's letter was 'not at all of a censuring or cautioning character', the historian in him grapples with the devotee, and he manages to quote one line from